Christopher Tonetti

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Contact Information

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Current Appointments

Stanford University Graduate School of Business
Associate Professor of Economics (2017–present; tenured Sep 2021)
Assistant Professor of Economics (2013–2017)

National Bureau of Economic Research
Research Associate—EFG (2022–present)
Faculty Research Fellow—EFG (2015–2022)

Education

New York University, Ph.D. in Economics (May 2013)
Committee: Thomas Sargent (adviser), Gianluca Violante (adviser),
Jess Benhabib, Boyan Jovanovic, Ricardo Lagos

Columbia University, B.A. in Economics–Mathematics (May 2005)

Past Appointments

Editor, *Journal of Political Economy Macroeconomics* (2022–2025)
Member of the Founding Editorial Board

Associate Editor, *Review of Economic Dynamics* (2020–2022)

Peter B. Kenen Fellow, Princeton University (2018–2019 AY)

Assistant Economist at the Federal Reserve Bank of New York (2005–2007)

Published Journal Articles

Cognitive Decline, Limited Awareness, Imperfect Agency, and Financial Well-being
Ameriks, J., A. Caplin, M. Lee, M. D. Shapiro, and C. Tonetti,
American Economic Review: Insights (2023), 5 (1), 125–140.

Reconciling Models of Diffusion and Innovation:
A Theory of the Productivity Distribution and Technology Frontier
Benhabib, J., J. Perla, and C. Tonetti,
Econometrica (2021), 89 (5), 2261–2301.

Equilibrium Technology Diffusion, Trade, and Growth
Perla, J., C. Tonetti, and M. E. Waugh,
American Economic Review (2021), 111 (1), 73–128.

Nonrivalry and the Economics of Data
Jones, C. I. and C. Tonetti,
American Economic Review (2020), 110 (9), 2819–2858.

Long-Term-Care Utility and Late-in-Life Saving
Ameriks, J., J. Briggs, A. Caplin, M. D. Shapiro, and C. Tonetti,
Journal of Political Economy (2020), 128 (6), 2375–2451.

Older Americans Would Work Longer If Jobs Were Flexible
Ameriks, J., J. Briggs, A. Caplin, M. Lee, M. D. Shapiro, and C. Tonetti,
American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics (2020), 12 (1), 174–209.

Small Sample Properties of Bayesian Estimators of Labor Income Processes
Nakata, T. and C. Tonetti,
Journal of Applied Economics (2015), 18 (1), 122–148.

Equilibrium Imitation and Growth
Perla, J., and C. Tonetti,
Journal of Political Economy (2014), 122 (1), 52–76.

Catch-up and Fall-back through Innovation and Imitation
Benhabib, J., J. Perla, and C. Tonetti,
Journal of Economic Growth (2014), 19 (1), 1–35.

Collateral Values by Asset Class: Evidence from Primary Securities Dealers
Bartolini, L., S. Hilton, S. Sundaresan, and C. Tonetti,
Review of Financial Studies (2011), 24 (1): 248–278.

Published Comments

Comment on 'Tarnishing the Golden and Empire States:
Regulations and the U.S. Economic Slowdown,' by Herkenhoff, Ohanian, and Prescott
Tonetti, C., *Journal of Monetary Economics* (2018), 93, 110–113.

Working Papers

Risk Markups
Di Tella, S., C. Malgieri, and C. Tonetti,
Journal of Political Economy (2025), Revise and Resubmit.

Customers and Retail Growth
Einav, L., P. Klenow, J. Levin, R. Murciano-Goroff, and C. Tonetti,
The Review of Economic Studies (2026), Revise and Resubmit.

Past Automation and Future A.I.: How Weak Links Tame the Growth Explosion
Jones, C. I. and C. Tonetti (2026)

Risky Insurance: Life-cycle Insurance Portfolio Choice with Incomplete Markets
Briggs, J., C. Rogers, and C. Tonetti (2026)

Identification of Marginal Treatment Effects using Subjective Expectations
Briggs, J., A. Caplin, S. Leth-Petersen, and C. Tonetti (2026)

Beliefs and Realities of Work and Childcare After Childbirth
Caplin, A., S. Leth-Petersen, and C. Tonetti
AEJ: Applied Economics (2026), Revise and Resubmit.

Due Diligence: Endogenous Information Acquisition and Offer Quality in Search and Matching
Briggs, J., A. Caplin, M. Giezek, D. Martin, and C. Tonetti (2026)

Work in Progress

The Value of a Job
Caplin, A., V. Gregory, S. Leth-Petersen, J. Sæverud, C. Tonetti, and G. Violante

Dormant Working Papers

The Wealth of Wealthholders
Ameriks, J., A. Caplin, M. Lee, M. D. Shapiro, and C. Tonetti (2023)

Knowledge Diffusion Through Networks
Allen, T., K. Bilir, Z. Chen, and C. Tonetti (2019)

The Long-Term-Care Insurance Puzzle: Modeling and Measurement
Ameriks, J., J. Briggs, A. Caplin, M. D. Shapiro, and C. Tonetti (2018)

A Bayesian Approach to Imputing a Consumption-Income Panel Using the PSID and CEX
Smith, M. E., and C. Tonetti (2014)

Non-Refereed Publications

Estimating Demand for Improved Long-Term Care Insurance
Ameriks, J., J. Briggs, A. Caplin, M. D. Shapiro, and C. Tonetti,
The State of Long-Term Care Insurance: The Market, Challenges and Future Innovations (2016), 57–69.
CIPR study, National Association of Insurance Commissioners.

Professional Activities

Conference Organization and Service

Co-organizer, Macroeconomic Policy Perspectives Conference (2026)
Co-organizer, FRB San Francisco Growth Conference (2026)

Program Committee, Econometric Society World Congress (2025)
Co-organizer, NBER Economic Fluctuations and Growth (EFG) Summer Institute Meeting (2023)
Program Committee, Econometric Society NA Winter Meeting (2023)
Co-organizer, SITE Summer Workshop: "Macroeconomics and Inequality" (2018, 2019, 2021, 2022)
Co-organizer, NBER Household Finance (HF) Summer Institute Meeting (2019, 2022)
Steering Committee, NBER Household Finance (HF) Small Grants Program (2022, 2023)
Co-organizer, NBER Household Finance (HF) Conference: "Innovative Data in Household Finance" (2020)
Co-organizer, NBER Economic Growth (EFEG) Winter Meeting (2019)
Co-organizer, Minnesota Workshop in Macroeconomic Theory (2018)
Program Committee, Society for Economic Dynamics (2015, 2016, 2017)
Co-organizer, NYU Alumni Conference (2015)

Affiliations

Macroeconomic Policy Perspectives Advisory Board (2024–present)
Senior Fellow, Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (2021–present)
Advisor, Risk Labs' Universal Market Access (UMA) (2018–present)
Visiting Scholar, FRB San Francisco (2016–2022)
Visiting Scholar, FRB Minneapolis, Opportunity and Inclusive Growth Institute (2021–2022 AY)

Invited Extended Visits

Yale University, Cowles Foundation Macroeconomics Program (1 week—Feb 2019, November 2024)
Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, IEM Visiting Scholar (2 weeks—March 2015)

Awards and Grants

Botha-Chan Faculty Scholar, Stanford GSB (2023–2024, 2024–2025, 2025–2026)

Business School Trust Faculty Scholar, Stanford GSB (2021–2022)

John A. Gunn and Cynthia Fry Gunn Faculty Scholar, Stanford GSB (2020–2021)

Fletcher Jones Faculty Scholar, Stanford GSB (2017–2018)

"Insurance Demand and Policy Non-Payment Beliefs" grant, NBER Household Finance (2016–2017),
Christopher Tonetti (PI), Amount Awarded $18,000

"Government Policies, Savings, and Labor Supply of Older Workers" grant,
The Sloan Foundation (2016–2018), Andrew Caplin (PI), Amount Awarded $696,815

Graduate School of Business Trust Faculty Scholar, Stanford GSB (2015–2016)

"The Growth Dynamics of Innovation, Diffusion, and the Technology Frontier,"
Hampton Research Grant, University of British Columbia (2014),
Jesse Perla (PI), Amount Awarded $22,000

"Older Americans and the Labor Market" grant, The Sloan Foundation (2012),
Andrew Caplin (PI), Amount Awarded $487,109

Henry M. MacCracken Fellowship, New York University (2007–2013)

Erwin H. Leiwant Mathematics Scholarship, Columbia University (2003–2005)

Invited Seminars

2026: IMF, Rice, UCLA, U Chicago

2025: Peking University HSBC Business School, LBS, LSE, IIES

2024: Yale, NYU, Harvard, FRB Minneapolis, Duke, Princeton Finance

2023: FRB St. Louis, UCSD, Keio, Kyoto, Tokyo, Hitotsubashi, Copenhagen Business School Finance, University of Copenhagen, Central European University, UC Irvine

2022: Toronto, NYU Stern Finance, Wisconsin, Peking University INSE

2020–2021: Tel Aviv, MIT Sloan Finance, Clemson, BI Norwegian Business School, Nottingham

2019: Maryland, Duke, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, Bocconi University, European University Institute, Sciences Po, Arizona State University, NYU, MIT Trade, Princeton Trade, FRB New York, Yale

2018: Boston University, Columbia GSB, Penn State, FRB San Francisco, UC Santa Cruz, FRB Minneapolis

2017: Carlos III Madrid, IIES, University of Zurich, USC CESR, Yale

2016: Chicago Booth, Northwestern, Carnegie Mellon, Dartmouth, UBC, FRB Chicago, UC Riverside, UC San Diego, Harvard

2015: UCLA, Santa Clara, Houston, FRB Atlanta, FRB New York, FRB Minneapolis

2014: Penn, Columbia, Alberta, UC Irvine, Institute for Fiscal Studies, Northwestern, USC, Princeton Macro, Princeton Trade

2013: Wharton, UC Davis, Wisconsin, Rochester, FRB San Francisco, Yale, Brown, Michigan, Boston University, Chicago Booth, Minnesota, FRB St. Louis, LSE, Stanford GSB, Berkeley

2012: FRB Minneapolis

2011: Cornell

Conference Presentations

2026: NBER SI: Economic Fluctuations and Growth Program Meeting, Society for Economic Dynamics (Athens), Pacific Macro Conference (Kona)

2025: Empirical Macro Workshop (New Orleans), Princeton Macro-Finance Conference, Society for Economic Dynamics (Copenhagen), Pacific Macro Conference (Kona), St. Louis Fed-WashU-LAEF Macro-Labor Conference (FRB St. Louis)

2024: e61 Micro 4 Macro Workshop (Sydney), Empirical Macro Workshop (Miami), NBER SI: Micro Data and Macro Models Workshop, Society for Economic Dynamics (Barcelona), Pacific Macro Conference (Kona)

2023: Empirical Macro Workshop (Phoenix), Philadelphia Workshop on Macroeconomics and Economic Policy, NBER SI: Household Finance Workshop, Society for Economic Dynamics (Cartagena), Jackson Hole Macro Workshop, Misallocation and Risk (ASSA 2023), Survey Data in Macroeconomics and Finance (ASSA 2023)

2022: *Nature*: Forum on Empowering Data as A New Asset, Empirical Macro Workshop (Savannah), Society for Economic Dynamics (Wisconsin)

2020–2021: Empirical Macro Workshop (Los Angeles), Econometric Society European Summer Meeting (2021), Society for Economic Dynamics (Minneapolis), Macroeconomics in the Age of AI (IMF), Peer Effects and Technology Adoption (ASSA 2020)

2019: Empirical Macro Workshop (Miami), FRB San Francisco & FinRegLab Data Symposium (Los Angeles), PAELLA (Notre Dame), Society for Economic Dynamics (St. Louis), Pizzanomics (EIEF), FRB Atlanta Financial Markets Conference, Theoretical Advances on Frictional Markets (Princeton), Big Data in the Modern Economy (ASSA 2019)

2018: NBER SI: Economic Growth Workshop, Society for Economic Dynamics (Mexico City), Macroeconomics of Pensions and Retirement Financing Conference (Minnesota), Empirical Macro Workshop (Las Vegas), Swiss Macro Workshop, Long-term-care Insurance (ASSA 2018), Trade and Technology Diffusion (ASSA 2018)

2017: REDg (Autònoma Barcelona), Society for Economic Dynamics (Edinburgh), The Diffusion of Knowledge (ASSA 2017), Parameter Estimation Using Online Household Surveys (ASSA 2017)

2016: Savings and Risks: Micro and Macro Perspectives (IFS), Society for Economic Dynamics (Toulouse), ASU Young Scholars Conference: Growth and Development

2015: West Coast Search & Matching Workshop (USC), Society for Economic Dynamics (Warsaw), NYU Alumni Conference, CIGS Conference on Macroeconomic Theory and Policy (Tokyo), Sargent Alumni Reading Group (NYU), Vanguard Research Initiative Workshop (NYU)

2014: Rational Inattention and Related Theories (Oxford), NBER SI: Aging Workshop, Society for Economic Dynamics (Toronto), Econometric Society NASM (Minneapolis), Estimation of Economic Models of Earnings Dynamics (ENSAE), Rational Inattention Workshop (PSE), Sargent Alumni Reading Group (NYU)

2013: MINYVan Conference (NYU), Conference on Understanding Economic Decision Making (Aspen), EEA Congress (Gothenburg), Society for Economic Dynamics (Seoul), New Faces in International Trade (Penn State), Michigan Retirement Research Center Workshop (U Michigan)

2012: FRB Philadelphia International Trade Workshop, Society for Economic Dynamics (Cyprus), Computing in Economics and Finance (Prague), FRB Chicago Rookie Conference

2011: Conference in Honor of Tom Sargent's Nobel Prize in Economics (NYU)

Discussions

2026: Firm Specialization vs. Diversification
by Anmol Bhandari, Sanhitha Jugulum, Laura Veldkamp, and Venky Venkateswaran
(NBER SI: Economic Growth and Long-Run Macroeconomic Development)

2024: Misallocative Growth
by Niklas Engbom (FRB San Francisco Micro Macro Labor Economics Conference)

Revisiting Retirement and Social Security Claiming Decisions
by Neha Bairoliya and Kathleen McKiernan (NBER SI: Household Finance)

Meritocracy across Countries
by Oriana Bandiera, Ananya Kotia, Ilse Lindenlaub, Christian Moser, and Andrea Prat
(NBER EFG Winter)

2023: Data Markets
by Ernest Liu, Song Ma, and Laura Veldkamp (Brookings Conference on Artificial Intelligence)

2022: Global Innovation and Knowledge Diffusion
by Nelson Lind and Natalia Ramondo (NBER SI: Economic Growth)

Dynamic Gains from Trade Agreements with Intellectual Property Provisions
by Ana Maria Santacreu (ASSA Session: International Dimensions of Intangibles and Market Power)

2021: Responsible Data Economy vs. Today's Data Markets and Underground Data Brokers
by Dawn Song (UC Berkeley—Wells Fargo Lab Workshop)

2020: The Effect of Political Frictions on Long Term Care Insurance
by Jessica Liu and Weiling Liu (ASSA Session: Household Finance—Regulation and Intermediation)

2019: Automation, Globalization and Vanishing Jobs: A Labor Market Sorting View
by Ester Faia, Sébastien Laffitte, Gianmarco Ottaviano, and Maximilian Mayer
(FRB San Francisco Micro Macro Labor Economics Conference)

Technological Transitions with Skill Heterogeneity Across Generations
by Rodrigo Adão, Martin Beraja, and Nitya Pandalai-Nayar (NBER EFG Fall)

A Growth Model of the Data Economy
by Maryam Farboodi and Laura Veldkamp (NBER SI: Economic Growth)

Immigration, Innovation and Growth
by Konrad Burchardi, Thomas Chaney, Tarek Hassan, Lisa Tarquinio, and Stephen Terry
(Princeton IES Summer Workshop)

Optimal Taxation With an Endogenous Growth Rate
by Ravi Jagadeesan (ASSA Session: Technological Progress and Inequality)

2018: Dancing with the Stars: Innovation through Interactions
by Ufuk Akcigit, Santiago Caicedo, Ernest Miguelez, Stefanie Stantcheva, and Valerio Sterzi
(FRB Atlanta Annual Employment Conference)

Can Financial Innovation Solve Household Reluctance to Take Risk?
by Laurent Calvet, Claire Celerier, Paolo Sodini, and Boris Vallee (NBER SI: Household Finance)

Consumption-led Growth
by Oleg Itskhoki, Markus Brunnermeier, and Pierre-Olivier Gourinchas
(NBER Economic Growth Winter)

2017: The Impact of Risk-Based Pricing in the Student Loan Market: Evidence from Borrower Repayment Decisions
by Natalie Cox (SIEPR Postdoctoral Fellows Conference)

The Global Productivity Distribution and Ricardian Comparative Advantage
by Thomas Sampson (Princeton IES Summer Workshop)

Demand for Long-term Care Insurance in Canada
by Martin Boyer, Philippe De Donder, Claude Fluet, Marie-Louise Leroux, and Pierre-Carl Michaud
(Stanford Next World Program Conference on Financing Longevity)

Tarnishing the Golden State: Regulations and the U.S. Slowdown
by Kyle F. Herkenhoff, Lee E. Ohanian, and Edward C. Prescott (Carnegie-Rochester-NYU)

2016: Globalization and Synchronization of Innovation
by Kiminori Matsuyama, Iryna Sushko, and Laura Gardini (NBER SI: ITM)

Endogenous Technology Adoption and R&D as Sources of Business Cycle Persistence
by Diego Anzoategui, Diego Comin, Mark Gertler, and Joseba Martinez
(FRB San Francisco Conference on Macroeconomics and Monetary Policy)

2015: Reverse Speculative Attacks
by Manuel Amador, Javier Bianchi, Luigi Bocola, and Fabrizio Perri
(NYU Stern-FRB Atlanta International Workshop)

The Global Diffusion of Ideas
by Paco Buera and Ezra Oberfield (NBER SI: Economic Growth)

Macroeconomics and Heterogeneity
by Dirk Krueger, Kurt Mitman, and Fabrizio Perri (Stanford Handbook of Macroeconomics Vol. 2)

2014: Dynamic Selection: An Idea Flows Theory of Entry, Trade, and Growth
by Thomas Sampson (Princeton IES Summer Workshop)

2010: Search Frictions and the Liquidity of Large Blocks of Shares
by Rui Albuquerque and Enrique Schroth (NYU Alumni Conference)